#10 A. the changing nature of addiction ①

I have to surrender at each stage of recovery in this program . Mike W.

I heard a man say that every time he lost his faith in a fellow human being, he died a little bit. You in the program have given me so much to believe in that I want to live again.

#10 B. environment of recovery (2)

ATLANTA LITERATURE COMMITTEE 10-21-79 Brock & Amanda's

Relationships

-no relationships 1st Year
-not so important what you do with your body as what you ~~did~~ do with your mind.
-after sex person vulnerable to relapse, especially if partner is using.
-Tell potential partner at beginning of relationship that you're going to put your recovery first.
- Activities release tension. Clean partying can help.

(9) *0055.

Sobriety is a commonality of mind and spirit that emerges as we recover We discuss and condider many things that lend to certain conclusionsthat enable us to participate in a certain consciousness. This consciousness allo us to accept our lives as they are. Acceptance frees us to feel human Our sense of humanity guides us to take better care of ourselves and to become useful to others This process is guided and reassociated by the twelve step and the principles of N. O . W. Any use of chemicals organic or alcohol disrupts the process and by shifting our perceptive from spiritual growth and concern for others to selfish concern
My self worth is directly proportional to my gratitude Mike K.

In our desparate search for approval we become victims of special promiscuity We can't be everything to everyone nor should we try

The only way to win a losing battle is to give up

Pain becomes a correctional force when we surrender

An eighty-four year old priest wondered on his death bed if he was going to heaven or hell. St, Peter and Moses came to the foot of the bed. He asked them and they said to come with them. They went to a room with a bowl in the middle of the table and people sitting around with long spoons. They starved and the priest felt that this was hell, because the long handles would not permit them to reach the bowl and get the food to their mouths. He was taken to another room and in the same situation the people were happy and well fed. They had learned to feed each other.

I REMEMBER WHEN I FIRST CAME INTO THE "SCENE" EVERYONE TALKING ABOUT THE EXPERIENCE. WHAT IT WAS THEY WERE TALKING ABOUT I WASN'T SURE BUT I KNEW THAT IT HAD SOMETHING TO DO WITH THE DRUGS.

#10-B- ENVIRONMENT OF RECOVERY (3)

As a program we need to love and cherish our newcomers, ~~especially~~ men and women, wishing them the best in their new lives. Our program is the twelve steps, twelve traditions and principles, going to meetings daily, getting a sponsor, getting a home group and asking for help. We become concerned about our relationships when our recovery is threatened. Where we come from, relationships had a certain "value" in our lives. We need new values in recovery.

One thing that occurs to someone helping another is how hard it is. ~~Recog~~ Recognizing this difficulty helps me forgive people who seem to have let us down in the past.

#10-B- ENVIRONMENT of RECOVERY (4)

-When in doubt, leave it out.
-Relationships can threaten personality change. If we find ourselves changing and it interfers with our true love, a lot of us think that the other person is more important than our recoveries. If only we can break through to that special person, we will be happy. A lot of our past ideas about things lead us to believe that if only we can be part of a family unit, we will be happy. It has been our experience that only by learning to deal with our underlying addiction can we even have a chance of happiness. The growth which comes through working the Twelve Steps has enabled many of us to enjoy freedom in this area of our lives for the first time. In the program we meet a wide variety of people, seeking help from a loving powerm greater than ourselves. Our motive is important. The main question we have to ask ourselves is how is this going to affect our recovery.

-What's right for one might be wrong for another.
-Priorities: My purpose today is to stay clean and sober and what lengths am I willing to go to maintain my recovery.
-We often fall in heat and think it's love.
-KISS Our tendancy to complicate matters may lead us into a self-destructive relationship just when we might have had a special breakthrough in recovery or insight into our addiction. If we are spiritualy weak a relationship that points up character defects or forces us to deal with the wreackage of our past before we have reached these steps can trigger a relapse.
- Those of us who have suffered a lot in our active addiction oftentimes have desperate notions of what recovery may offer. Those who have a measure of ongoing recovery can look back and and see one or more close calls involving relationships. We have learned as not to set ourselves up for a fall by giving advice or telling fellow members what to do, we can best serve by sharing what it was like for us and that the near pleasure has threatened our ongoing happiness.
- Until we get it right inside, it is doubtful our outside experience of life and recovery will improve.
- Many of us have learned to emphasize our basic humanity over our masculine/femine distinction as part of our recovery experience.

(10)

0052

for help at meetings, we embark on an adventure that willgive us new lives. Where we were agressively strong, we will learn moderation. Where we were weak we draw strength. Balance ber becomes apparent in our lives and the feeling of it might have been slips away.

(9)

#10-B-ENVIORNMENT RECOVERY

0055

(5)

Catch phrases called tools are used to emphasize routinly sucesswful techniques for daily living. Let go and let God, easy does it, step don't run, one day at a time all help the new member become established in the program. A special effort is made by members to help the new person become acquainted with the new way of life. The things a new person hears are simply the things that worked for the person sharing them. A problem of any sort can be mentioned at a meeting and someone there has likely had a similiar problem or experience and will come over after the meeting and share on that particular thing. On of the ways the program works is by bypassing the massive ego of the new addict by waiting until they actually ask for help. Sharing on anx actual past experience you have been thruugh means more than any good advice. Maybe addicts have learned to trust some feelings more than words. You can tell when some one is talking down to you and noone like it. After the dust has settled and the newcomer has become acquainted with the tools and the Stpps by description, they are usually ready to begin working the Steps. Exceptions must be made for the many who have been damaged so severly in their minds or spirits that just staying clean keeps them busy. Even in these cases the sooner they can begin the sooner their real recovery can begin.

Actually taking the white chip or whatever token of acceptance into the gruup applies begins the first step.

1. We admitted that we were powerless over our add addiction, that our lives had become unmanageablà.

To take the stap entirely requires a period of abstinence and a fair measure of improvement so that the person

#10-B-Enviornment of Recovery

(6)

Time in the program heals

Addicts expert at pissing off straight people but can't fool fellow addict -- ultimate weapon for recovered addict himself.

IN THE PROGRAM WE ARE OFFERED AN EXPERIENCE THAT NO DRUG ON THIS EARTH CAN OFFER. IN OUR SPIRITUAL ~~AWAKENING~~ AWAKENING GOD COMES BACK INTO OUR LIVES AND WE ARE GIVEN FAITH IN SOMETHING OTHER THAN OURSELVES

0019

(10)

KNOW WE CANT DO IT ALONE. WE ARE GIVEN HOPE FOR WE KNOW THAT A BETTER DAY IS COMING AND WE ARE GIVEN LOVE THE GREATEST GIFT OF ALL.

AND WITH LOVE WE BEGIN TO LOOK AT OUR BROTHERS AND SISTERS AND BECOME WILLING TO DO WHATEVER IS IN OUR POWER TO ~~DO WHATEVER~~ GIVE ~~OUR~~ THEM WHAT WE HAVE. AND OUR FELLOWSHIP GROWS AND KEEPS ON GROWING AND LIKE OUR HIGHER POWER HAS NO END.

MY FREINDS THIS IS THE EXPERIENCE

#10-B-ENVIORNMENT OF RECOVERY (7)

Many of us practice some form of daily meditation and include reading material of a spiritual nature that reminds us of our disease and offers different points of view to revitalize our living. We suggest you find what works for you.

Many of us practice some form of daily meditation and include reading material of a spiritual nature that reminds us of our disease and offers different points of view to revitalize our living. We suggest you find what works for you.

We carry the tools of our program with us and find their practice of benefit in our new way of life. In particular, the serenity prayer embodies the guiding principles of whange which grant us recovery. Accepting things we cannot change relieves us of fighting losing battles. This frees us to direct our energies into more constructive channels. Acceptance becomes an active principle we use in dealing with people, places and things beyond our control. Acceptance of what is, what we do when nothing else can be done.

Change involves the unknown. Change involves courage in areas that really matter. The same Higher Power that has helped us withstand our compulsion to use, will be our source of courage when we ask.

The wisdom to know the difference involves growth in the program. We come to know what to do or what to avoid doing in areas where before we knew only defeat. This knowledge usually comes as we learn to remove self-will from the picture through our willingness.

convention of Narcotics anonomous in 1980. Wonderful visions filled our minds and our hearts as we listened. We would not have this at all times , th is lofty de sire to do Gods will come Hell or High water, We would of course fall short . T e twe lve steps of NA t thee princples of recovery that pick us up and lift our again to that vision again. See that the common welfare comes first and that our competitive and sick egos should never get so out of hand that we st umble and fall. We are not ever to be recovered , truek , addiction is unrelenting through out life. We will be subject to dry dry run s from time to time. Powerless over our addictions perhaps from the moment of our conceptions, we become drug addicts when we first use mind altering or mood changeing drugs. Every boy we knew was using but wewere different it made us sick and we couldnt stop, if and when our friends did. It was not our culture that made us dope fiends . It was

(8)

#10 C.

Self Hate is rooted in the fact that we strongly disapprove of ourselves. In other words we have judged ourselves and found ourselves wanting

TODAY I HAVE FEELINGS, REAL FEELINGS OF ~~NOT~~ LOVE, JOY, HOPE, EXITMENT, SADNESS (OF VARIANT DEGREES) FRIENDSHIP. BEFORE I WAS EITHER SUPER EXITED OR SUPER DEPRESSED VERY LITTLE INBETWEEN. 0160

TODAY I CAN EMPTY ASTRAYS AFTER A MEETING, AND FEEL GOOD ABOUT MYSELF.

#10 C. Self-revelation + etc,

work in: when I heard about Susan, not being able to talk for two years coming close to getting busted, beating up the guy for ripping off the weed, some of the hopes and dreams that made me self destructive because I was falling so far short of the goals I was setting for myself, figuring I was a bad person because bad things kept happening to me, never suspecting my addiction until I reached the point of asking could it be the dope?

As the layers of guilt, remorse and shame were gradually removed by working the Twelve Steps of our Program, I found out that I had set myself and impossible task. The world, as I percieved it through my fog of addiction seem to demand certain things of me amd I accepted these ch charges without even considering the source. I got busy trying to live up to these false expectations and got in trouble quick. I would get loaded, get another running start and go back to trying to make the impossibel work. In Recovery I try to be a little more grateful and a little more reluctant to comit myself to things I don't really care about. I am very grateful for all the beautiful people, places and things in my life. Most of all I am grateful for ongoing conscious contact with God as I understand Him. Whenevr I confront a difficulty that I know I can't handle, I have learned to pray the prayer that God do for me what I cannot do for myself, if it be Thy Will! Willingness lets me relax and do what I can a day at a time to improve my life in any area. When I was unwilling, I had to fight and constantly deny the need for improvement. Doing what I can proves I am willing and I know that I can only do so much in a day. but by doing that I am kept busy solving problems instead of creating them. I used to just freeze up.

Try to get the program till it becomes your idea . As long as its somebody elses idea we'll resist . When it becomes our idea we'll start working it

The word that saved our lives identify

Life has many brick walls for us Clean and sober we can better see these dead end courses of concern we wont feel the need to pursue them.

Discovered I could change my mind by taking the second step. Circumstances dont make the man they reveal him to himself.

We surrender twice coming to the program: once to addiction and once to the program. Step three gets us out of the center of the universe. Step ten: we must be rid of the defect to promptly admit fault.

Watch the thoughts you are forming, they are becoming you. 10-C

What every recovering drug addict wants more than anything else is to feel good about themselves. If we beco e actively self-destructive, we die.

I want to be me because I've spent so much time on me. If I had to start over on so eone else it would be more than I cou d Handle.

#10 C. self-revelation etc. 0068 (10)

NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

WSC Literature Committee • 890 Atlanta Road, Marietta, Georgia 30060 • 404/427-2086

April 1980
Hank
Finch

I nvever have been known to write well when Im hurting like this but Ive heard that it is when you stay clean and sober when thier semems to be no reason to live those are the people who seem to make it in this pro gram maybe I forgot to remember what exacty it was to hurt but I thought it is supposed to get better. AT least I dont have to hurt alone Iam over at my sponsers house. maybe I have lost my unconditional willingness to stay clean. I,m talking about when the newcomers you try to talk to dont want to talk and there aint no nothing between you and that pill, fix or drink and you question every thought youthink and God wants to help you but your to sick or either wont seek help. Your going to school and the people think wow he is doing so good your afriad to relenquish contoll by telling your so mad its not working out like you wanted it to and itshould have all the angles were covered and your girl friend who was dieing to see you and now you called her she was going to callyou but when you peretend he,ll doit it will be done and everone thisthat and the other and your not making any sense to your self and cant see any good comin g off ot and you really have totrust god and no one you talk to hasany answers and no book you read will help , and you wonder how you can in your tiny way beof service to the whole how you can not help your self but if you can be ofservice to some one else just for amoment you will get alittle releif from your defeatist attitude even if you die an early death cause you burnt you out helping someone and didnt take proper care of you. cause you just a fucked up little moron any way sittin at your sponsers house and your way dont work and he cant help you and you on such different levls then he says that which helps it sounds good you want to believe it yiu try to get up inside but it cant be that simple and your really just putiing itoffany way and youdont

know what your puttig off .dont know cant trust your head and you had to do it the books way any bodies way you been here before and doneit but you still looking for anther way and thier is none and you feel you feelings comingback to you,but you know its god and something in you wont give in and wont die somethig in discust rallies in the very core of your soul just like it did all those times when it whs all over and was just going to kill yourslf by someself 'distruction, when you were locjed up whenyou had just died livind death andsomething says you aint gona die you aint never gona die and it blows allythe pussey shit away get behind me with all yeuve got you aint never gioing to die motherfucker ever dont you know that havent we been through this befoe. then what I thought I needed is shit is habit some thing I have only to put up with and let fall by the wayside for though alot of me may be dead I well live. though others may seeem , the voice says get behind me and no one or nothing else and of your self or lot you know nothing. nothing. nothing. nothing nothing . onot athing fallow throw the hell .

#10 D Self adjusting (11)

recovery of a suffering addict from a friendly distance and getting to help when asked is one of the great experiences this life has to offer.

0057

In time we will find our own place in the world and take it. It may be new to us or quite familiar. The ability to accept our place and be grateful for it is very special. Many of us have great opportunities in our lives but were faced with a baffling inability to accept them of make the most of them. When you pray for something you have spiritually prepared yourself for the relization of your prayer. Knowledge of God's will for us guides us to make wise choices when we pray. If God forced his goodness on us we could never learn to distinguish good from bad. and enjoy the great happiness of a spiritual person. We would be like robots without knowledge of choice. Individuals constitute society as a whole. Individuals may be very different and still have much to offer. It is the ability of human society to include such divergent types that gives us the resource to deal with all the problems society faces. We have people to mind the store, maintain law and order in cases of conflict, to lead, to serve, to alert the public conscience, to pass our learning to the young, to develope and maintain the technology. There is literally a place for everyone.

We as addicts will want to constantly remind ourselves that there are plenty of people ready and able to help us whatever our difficulty if only we ask for help.

#10-D

(12)

********** ***** CHANGING TIMES ***** *****

Remember when "hippie" meant "big in the hips"?
And a "trip" involved travel in cars, planes and ships?
When "pot" was a vessel for cooking things in,
And "hooked" was what grandmother's rugs would have been?
When "fix" was a verb that meant "mend" or "repair,"
And to be "in" meant merely existing somewhere?
When "neat" meant "well-organized, tidy and clean,"
And "grass" was a ground cover - normally green?
When "groovy" meant furrowed with channels and hollows,
And "birds" were winged creatures like robins and swallows?
When "fuzz" was a substance real fluffy - like lint,
And "bread" came from bakeries - not from the mint?
When "roll" was a bun, and "rock" was a stone,
And "hangup" was something you did with a phone?
When lights (not people) were turned on and off,
And "the pill" was something you took for a cough?
When a "swinger" was someone who swung in a swing,
And a "pad" was a soft sort of cushiony thing?
When "far out" meant distance - a long way away,
And no one thought twice when you said they were "gay"?

To live in the world of insanity is difficult to describe to those who have never experienced it.

Even today, in the state of near remission, it is often difficult to evoke the old chaos of which my world once consisted.

All persons have within themelves an imput control--as the selector on a radio. Receiving all existing channels at once would do little for the frail human mind. Similarily, it would be difficult to read, carry on a conversation or do anything if one could not block off other imputs, other conversations (audio imput), observing the environment (visual) or worse, one's own wandering mind.

Holdbacks reluctance to commit to prayer Al laziness unworked steps

Take your time its all we really have.

You are my eyes my ears when I do something wrong you help me help myself by showing me what I cannot see.

Each day clean and sober we beat the odds against out recovery

Death perception comes back. Ed Odonnel

10-D

When it feels like things arent going your wy way God usually hassomething better in store for you

If luck is not on your side you have no reason to hurry If luck is on your side you have no reason to hurry-Bill Mck.

#10-D

(13)

My need s are better than my wants My wants get me in situations that hurt me
Rebecca

Addiction to me as an a dict is pain
Operating and nearly clean I used to wonder ho w people could achieve manageability I didnt know that they didnt really understand it anymore than I did but they could accept the things they couldnt understand better than I could

In working the second step it is helpful to work on your belief Most of our belief before working the second step is really assumption.

When you change yourself you change the people around you.even if its the same people.

Religion is learned Spiritual is felt. Ed C.
As addiction is progressive so is recovery. Mike W.
Maybe its the Dope Bo S.

I used to use "Were not saints " out of context to suit my indescretion.Billy

I used drugs and felt like my life was make belie e I dug it until my whole life became make believe Allen L.

---

the Program doesn't work when we adapt it to our lives; We have to adapt our lives to the Program.

(10)

#p-D

(14)

#0050

I feel like when I took the second step, the war inside of me was over. I do not have to deal with my insanity as much anymore. If on a daily basis I continue to take this step, I continue to know a new peace and ~~xxxxxxxxxxxx~~ freedom from my old insanity.

Guilt about the past and woorry about the future keep us messed about today. 00"

If you have calmness in your heart , you will find peace in your soul.

How about MUSTS in NA- 10-D

Four stages of growth sloth business, idealization realization

#0055

NOTES:
Lack of faith or belief can block God's will for us and interrupt a course of growth. When we grow, our need for a power, greater than ourselves, increases.

Use your friends and the program, not the dope.

a-01

If I ever learn to keep my mouth shut, especially about what or who I am, my life will improve 50%.

If you strgy ta far from common sense to far you will die.

A l t of trouble I've brought on myself because I couldn't kee[illegible]

[illegible] of me can hurt me but the expectations I place on them can

Cindy A

In the program we give not only love and encouragement but small tasks that allow the recovering addict to feel good about themselves and get used to sucess gradually.

The book should tell of our experiences co i g in and dur ng the various suceeding stages of ~~xxxxxxxxxx~~ personal growth and recovery.

Steps 4 thru 9 help us get rid of the things that keep us from doing better.

10-D

(15)

Self will is a persons conception of what is or what should be. Bo S

We find in difficulty tha we can survive more and more things clean and sober We are more important than things. 10-D

What we do or abstain from doing has the power to cancel out past behavior some tims the only important event in the day will be the fact that we are still clean and sober. 10-D

Boomerang Phenomenan Many come to us unable to get the program but many of these come back and get it . Dont be discouraged we are all miracles

A lot of trouble I've brought on myself because I couldn't keep my mouth shut. 10-D

Let go of explanations; those who mind don't matter, those who matter don't mind. 10-D

We come to understand so slowly Never been punished for charachter defects We were punished by them. Cindy A

Aman who lives in a furnace is always in a hurry to be somewhere else. 10-D

Watch the thoughts you are forming, they are becoming you.

#10 E open mindedness (16)

********** PRINCIPLES OVER PERSONALITIES ********** 8107

When I started working the N.A. Program, I was told to love my fellow addicts. Well, I do love everyone; but there are a lot of people I don't like. As a matter of fact, because of character defects and personality differences, there are a lot of people who I don't see eye to eye with.

At one point of time, I used this as an excuse to stay away from the Program and thus stay loaded. I was dieing because I couldn't stand being around people whom I thought were full of shit! The reality of this was that I was more of a hypocrite than they were. At least they were staying sober and had a chance to change and grow. What chance did I have? How could I grow if I couldn't even stay sober?

Today I'm able to place principles before personalities. I work my own program and I do it for me. The 12 Steps are there for me to work, and so are some good people to help me. Yes, there are some people I still don't like; but then I guess there always will be. But, do you know what? I'm not going to die over that.

(A Recovering Addict)

When you start loving God God can start loving you.
Self Imposed crises we could not postpone.

Our thinking is the last thing to change, our actions have to change first.

. This first step is the most important step. We need to accept this step fully to start our road to recovery.

A way to secure safe and certain passage into a new life , where the old rules no longer apply and where we can live in peace with one another until the day we die .
I dont have any of the things I thought I had to have when I came to this program , but Ive found myself very happy clean and sober without these things Catherine F.

When I was using I thought I was having a ball and straight people were deprived of fun . Clean and sober Ive learned I have more fun and not have the loss of control that I had with drugs. The point of health is living to the fullest. God helps me live to the fullest without forgetting who I am and what Im about . I can love others better now that Im not so afraid Bo S
God sometimes grants me the ability to be aware of the obvious.

The controversy revolving around drug addicts attending AA meetings is valid . It involves the traditions of both programs People would not understand who had not studied or at least considered the traditions ,which preserve our groups and meetings . There is no corresponding controversy about alcoholics attending NA meetings , because addicts are welcome regardless of drug of choice.AA meetings exist to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers . Persons not seeking help with their alcohol addiction

#10 E open mindedness (17)

One thing that repeatedly comes to mind in sobriety is the obvious foolishness of forming sweeping opinions amd genera;izations with such limited perception

We often don't know what is going on. That is why we need to (reality) listen to those that do.

any positive expanding life style seems to demand the very things missing in addiction: Freedom, Goodwill, Personal Growth, & Creative Action.

(2)

With freedom, life is a meaningful, changing, and advancing process. It looks forward with a reasonable expectancy to a better and richer realization of our desires and a greater fulfillment of our personal selves. These are of course some of the manifestations of the spiritual progress that results from the daily practice of the 12 Steps of N.A.

Goodwill is an action that includes others besides ourselves, a way that considers as important in their own lives as we are in ours. It is hard to tell whether goodwill is the key to empathy or vice-versa. If we accept empathy as the capacity to see ourselves in others knowingly, without losing our own identity, then we recognize a sameness in both; and if we have accepted ourselves, how can we reject another? Affection comes from seeing similarities, intolerance from differences we fear and will not accept.

In personal growth we use both freedom and goodwill in cooperation with others. We realize we cannot live alone, that personal is also interpersonal. To find better balance, we examine spiritual, personal and social values as well as material values; maturity seems to demand this kind of evaluation. With active addiction, insanity, institutions are the only possibilities. With recovery through the help of a higher Power and the Steps of N.A., anything is possible.

Creative action is not a mysterious procedure, although it is an inside job in rebuilding or reintegrating our disordered and fractured personalities. Often it means simply listening to those hunches and intuitive feelings that we think would benifit others or ourselves, and acting on them spontaneously. Here is where many basic principles of action become apparent. We are then able to make decisions based on principles that have real value to ourselves.

As we become more God-reliant and gain in self-respect, we realize we are neither superior nor inferior to anyone; our real value lies in being ourselves. Self-awareness is a daily practice without end, a growing process of constant change and increasing humility, which leads to an expanding desire to be of service to others.

W #10 E Open mindedness #0112 (18)

Kathi: May, '78

Ever been in a conversation when something startling catches your attention and thoughts for even a moment. What if 99% of these distractions were not blocked out? What if you were trying to relate to another human being and you could not block out the ticking of the clock which a normal person whould screen out? And then the beauty of the table's wood grain entraps you and enfolds you with it. Worse, one does not lose track of the conversation--nothing seems to be possible to escape.

Imagine if you were aware at one time (perceptually) of every sound, every movement, every voice, every sight and every perception of personal vibration, as a radio with two channels bleeding together, all perception seems to become background noise with here and there a word or two in a row intelligible.

People's words are frequently as if in another language--only when expecting to hear a person speak and concentrating in advance makes the sounds meaningful.

(Even now when caught by surprize, I will be aware that words were spoken to me and the words I know were words, yet, a few horrifying moments pass before the experience changes and the relaying in my brain completes, allowing me to attach a thought to the sounds).

The most frustrating and frightening is in the middle, half able to screen; to follow a few words or sentences by intense concentration--then suddenly, it fades and is replaced by the awful volume of chaotic noise.

A sound of visual music errupts as distinct and I latch on hoping to hear something that has a pattern--then that fades out and chaos reigns moments only. Immediately then something else, just getting the feel and lost again.

The only choice then to withdraw, to surrender to chaos. Easier to live a life empty of meaningful stimuli and the constant roar and whirl of sounds and objects which are familiar and identifiable, which evoke no response within; trapped into a form of sensory deprivation long enough destroys the mind and soul.

Thank you God for sending me alcohol for before I grew strong enough through pain and endurance to fight I would have been lost forever in the kaleidoscope.

Awakening at 13 or 14 to the world. Sedation so deep as if to lower the volume of noise. Only very strong imput remained and in a form weak enough and slow enough to comprehend. Only drunk did I learn of the existence of other personalities, the beauty of a flower, the peace of the ocean, the warmth of the sun.

And finally, to dsire to enter that world permanently and fully--sober and comfortable.

The constant battle to think, feel, touch, hear and see.

Even pain is pleasure to a lip deadened by novacaine and pinched so that the awful nombness is erased.

(How much better to have normal awareness and feeling when the drug is gone).

Never, please God, the terrible kaleidoscope of perception. The meaninglessness of everything outside my school, the chaos and awful deathness within. To know that you only feel a small percentage of life.

Caring (love), contentment, peace, quietude, even the ability to have concern with others welfare are ecstasy unimaginable to the emotionally deprived.

Now I lay peacefully among the ocean's currents, moving slowly, unbelievably relaxed, enjoying the ride and waiting to see what the ocean sends me next to experience and feel. All I have to do is get the hell out of the riptides.